In fact, it appears that while a meeting did take place between Bhai Sahib Bhai Randhir Singh and Bhagat Singh, it was not an amicable one. Nor does it appear to have been one which Bhagat Singh himself desired. According to Shiv Verma, the article 'Why I Am an Atheist' actually came about when the Ghadarite Bhai Randhir Singh, during his own incarceration in Lahore Jail in 1930–31, wished to see Bhagat Singh. This is because,

> Baba Randhir Singh . . . was a God-fearing religious man. It pained him to learn that Bhagat Singh was a non-believer. He somehow managed to see Bhagat Singh in the condemned cell and tried to convince him about the existence of God, *but failed.* Baba lost his temper and said tauntingly: 'You are giddy with fame and have developed an ego which is standing like a black curtain between you and God.' It was in reply to that remark that Bhagat Singh wrote this article.[6] (emphasis added).

In 'Why I Am an Atheist', Bhagat Singh sets out the gradual process by which his belief in God had begun to disintegrate, explaining, 'I had stopped believing in God when I was an obscure young man . . .' even though 'my grandfather, under whose influence I was brought up is an orthodox Arya Samajist'. When Bhagat Singh was a student at 'the D.A.V School of Lahore and stayed in its Boarding House for a full one year', he was still very much a believer and 'used to recite "Gayatri Mantra" for hours and hours' to such an extent that 'I was a perfect devotee in those days'. However, it was when, '[i]n the Non-Cooperation days I joined the National College . . . that I began to think liberally and to criticise all religious problems, even about God'.[7] Thereafter, '[l]ater on I joined the revolutionary party' but still did not totally deny the existence of God. The change in him came when later on he 'got ample opportunity to study various ideals of the world revolution', and this is when 'I studied Bakunin, the anarchist leader, something of Marx, the father of communism, and much of Lenin, Trotsky and others – men who had successfully carried out a revolution in their country. They were all atheists'. The result was that '[b]y the end of 1926 I had been convinced as to the baselessness of the theory of existence of an almighty supreme being who created, guided and controlled the universe'.[8]